Boy Scouts Declining Enrollment



Presented by: Billy Horton, Jordan Davis, Derrick Sievert, Shariq Suhani, Farris Hallak

Executive Summary



Problem Description

Boy Scouts of America membership has steadily declined.

Research Questions

- To what extend are individuals aware of BSA programs and how to participate?
- What factors prevent individuals from joining or continuing participation in BSA?

Research Objective

Analyze and understand the key reasons for declining membership rates. Provide BSA with recommendations to increase membership.

Timeline History

1907

Robert Baden-Powell founds the Scouting movement in England

1910

The Boy Scouts of America (BSA) incorporated by William D. Boyce

1972

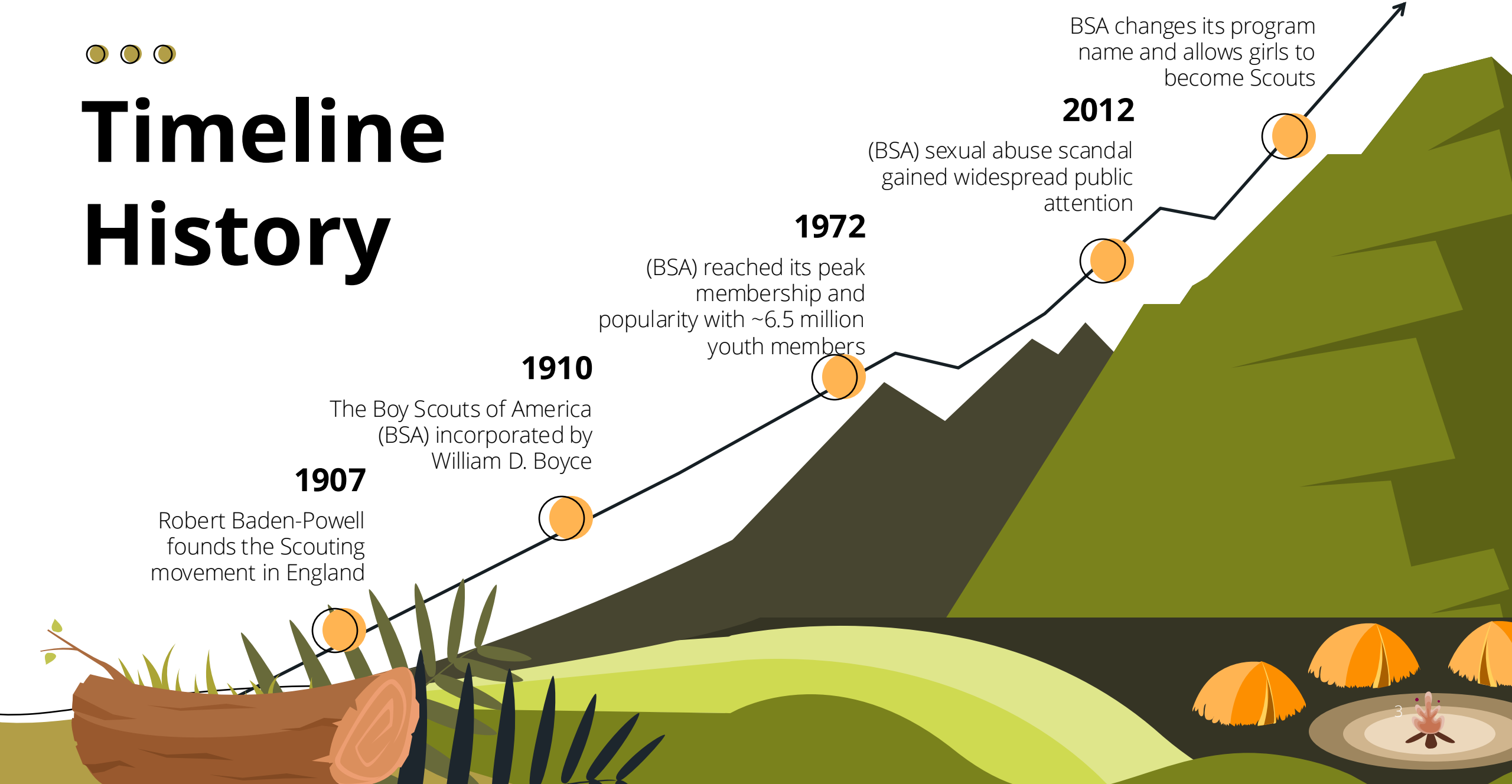
(BSA) reached its peak membership and popularity with ~6.5 million youth members

2012

(BSA) sexual abuse scandal gained widespread public attention

2019

BSA changes its program name and allows girls to become Scouts



Data Collection

01. Design

- Survey questionnaire
  - Measure perspective of the Boy Scouts of America
  - View feedback on what is causing decline

02. Target Population

- Students at UTD
  Friends / Family



03. Method of Sampling

- Convenience Sampling
  - Mainly chose people that we knew, or thought was most likely to respond

04. Survey Build

- Yes or No questions
- Multiple choice
- Rating
- Designed to be
  - Easy to understand
  - Clear
  - Easy to answer

Finding 1

Awareness

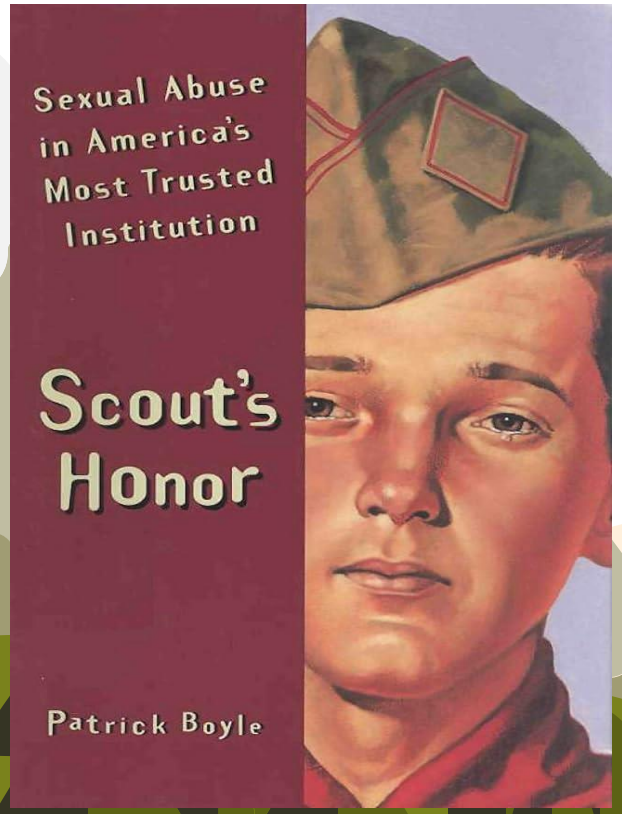
- 90% of respondents are aware of Scouting America
- 64% have been in, or knows someone, in Scouts
- Awareness spans multiple age groups (18-65+)

This suggests that the decline in participation is being driven by other factors rather than a lack of awareness.



Finding 2

Brand Perception







- 52% cite organization reputation (40% mention safety concerns)
- Negative media outweighs positive 5:1
- Concerns about program changes (Inclusion of girls mentioned repeatedly)

Overall, the data suggests that reputation challenges and internal changes are impacting how the brand is perceived, which may influence willingness to participate.

Finding 3

Strong Initial Interest



- 50% joined for outdoor/adventure skills
- Highest participation in K–5 (44%)
- Drops to 22% in high school
- Inconsistency in program experience (leadership quality & overall troop culture)

This suggests that while the concept of scouting is appealing, the actual experience can vary significantly — which may limit long-term engagement.

Finding 4

Competing Activities



- 56% prefer other activities
- 44% cite time commitment
- High demand for:
- Outdoor skills (64%)
- Short-term programs (56%)

This suggests that scouting is not necessarily competing on flexibility alone but rather losing priority to other structured activities — particularly sports and school-related commitments.





Limitations

01. Small Sample Size

This study is based on approximately 25 survey responses, limiting the ability to generalize findings to the broader population.

02. Age Distribution

A significant portion of respondents were adults outside the primary age range for scouting participation.

Recommendations

Boy Scouts of America must evolve from a traditional organization into a flexible, experience-driven brand that aligns with modern lifestyles and expectations.

Launch flexible adventure based programs	56% prefer other activities, 44% time constraints
Standardize troop experience & enforce accountability	Inconsistent experience, bullying, unequal opportunities
Rebuild trust through clear positioning and modern marketing	52% reputation concerns, perception barriers





Conclusion

Our research shows that awareness of Scouting America is still high, but participation keeps declining due to brand perception, inconsistent experience, and competing activities.

Awareness

Most respondents have heard of Scouting America, and many reported past exposure.

Perception & Experience

Reputation concerns and inconsistent experiences affect willingness to participate.

Competing Activities

Other activities and time commitment make long-term involvement harder to maintain.

Thank You

